

Calculated columns with DAX

# DAX syntax best practices

# Mastering DAX syntax

DAX syntax refers to the **rules** and **conventions** used to write DAX formulas. It includes **functions**, **operators**, and **expressions** that are used to manipulate and aggregate data.

01.

Basics of DAX

The basic syntax of DAX is **similar to spreadsheet formulas**, with additional functions and operators specific to Power BI.

02.

Why learn DAX syntax?

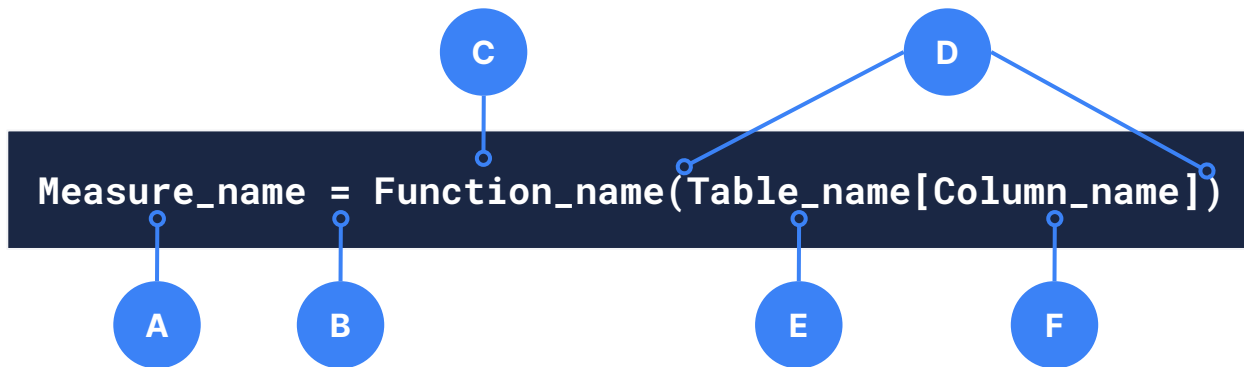
Learning how to create effective DAX formulas will help us **get the most out of our data** to solve real business problems that affect our bottom line.

03.

Who should use DAX guidelines?

Whether a beginner or an experienced user, everyone using DAX should adhere to these guidelines to enhance the **clarity and robustness** of one's Power BI projects.

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**A** The measure name.

**B** The equal sign indicates the **beginning of the formula**. When calculated, it will **return a result**.

**C** The **DAX function** to be used, for example, SUM.

Parentheses **surround an expression** that contains one or more arguments.

The referenced table.

The referenced column.

**D**

**E**

**F**

# DAX syntax best practices

## 01. Use clear and descriptive naming

- When naming tables, columns, measures, or variables, choose names that **clearly convey the purpose** or **content**.
- Opt for a naming convention that **aligns with your project** and **team standards**.
- Always **avoid generic names** or **abbreviations** that may lead to confusion.



### Do: clear and descriptive naming

```
Indicator_type =  
    RIGHT('Indicator'[Indicator_ID], 2)  
    == "EQ"
```



### Don't: generic names and abbreviations

```
Column_7 =  
    RIGHT( 'Data_1'[IID], 2 ) == "EQ"
```

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## 02. Consistent naming conventions

- Consistency should **be applied across all elements**, including tables, columns, measures, and variables within your DAX formulas.
- Adopting a standardised approach to naming **ensures that anyone working** on the project can **quickly interpret and navigate** the codebase.
- This practice **promotes collaboration, reduces errors**, and **enhances the overall maintainability** of our Power BI solution.



## Naming rules

- Within a single database all **tables must have unique names**.
- The names of the columns within each table must be unique:
  - Columns in different tables may possess the same names.
  - When the same column name is referenced from two or more tables, we must use a **fully qualified name** – that is, the 'Table\_name' followed by the [Column\_name].
- All objects (tables, columns, and measures) are **case insensitive**. For instance, the names 'DATE TABLE' and 'Date Table' would represent the same table.

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## 03. Format and indentation

- **Insert spaces around operators** to enhance code readability.
- **Use tabs to clearly indicate the hierarchy** of nested functions and improve code structure.
- When a function call has multiple arguments, **use carriage returns to separate** them. This improves the overall readability.



### Do: readable

```
Combined_indicator_ID =  
    IF(  
        'Indicator'[Indicator_gender] == BLANK(),  
        'Indicator'[Indicator_ID],  
        "Male or female"  
    )
```



### Don't: poor readability

```
Combined_indicator_ID=  
IF('Indicator'[Indicator_gender]==BLANK(),'Indicator'[Indicat  
or_ID],"Male or female")
```